



???



What is the greatest good?: **UTILITARIANISM**





AGENDA:

- **Understand and define utilitarianism;**
- **Appreciate the value of utilitarianism;**
- **Assess when to use it; and**
- **Apply utilitarianism.**

TOPICS COVERED:

01

**Origins and Nature
of the Theory**

02

**Jeremy
Bentham's
Utilitarianism**

03

**John Stuart Mill's
Utilitarianism**

04

**Utilitarianism in
Business**





1

Origins and Nature of the Theory





Utilitarianism

Do you think that Robin Hood is wrong in stealing from other people? Or you think it's ok since he is taking it from bad people anyway?

If one agrees or even applauds of Robin Hood's acts, then there is a strong chance that one is a Utilitarian.





Utilitarianism



A utilitarian believes that an action is morally right if it maximizes overall well- being and happiness.

The moral standard is based on the consequence of the action.

If the act will result in happiness and well- being of the majority, then that act is considered good.





2

Jeremy Bentham

"The said truth is that it is the greatest happiness of the greatest number that is the measure of right and wrong."



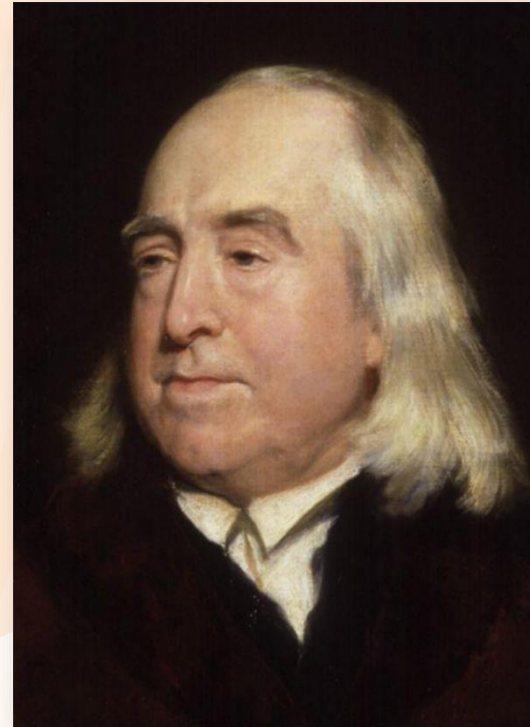


Hedonic Calculus



"An Introduction to the Principles of Morals and Legislation"

- **How intense the experience is?**
- **How long it lasts?**
- **Whether it will lead to similar types of experiences?**
- **How many people will be affected?**



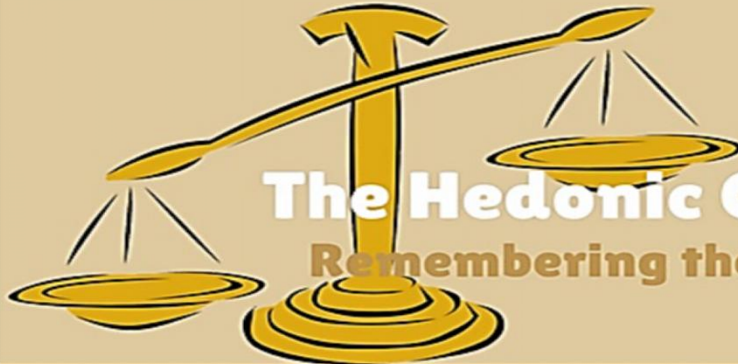


Hedonic Calculus

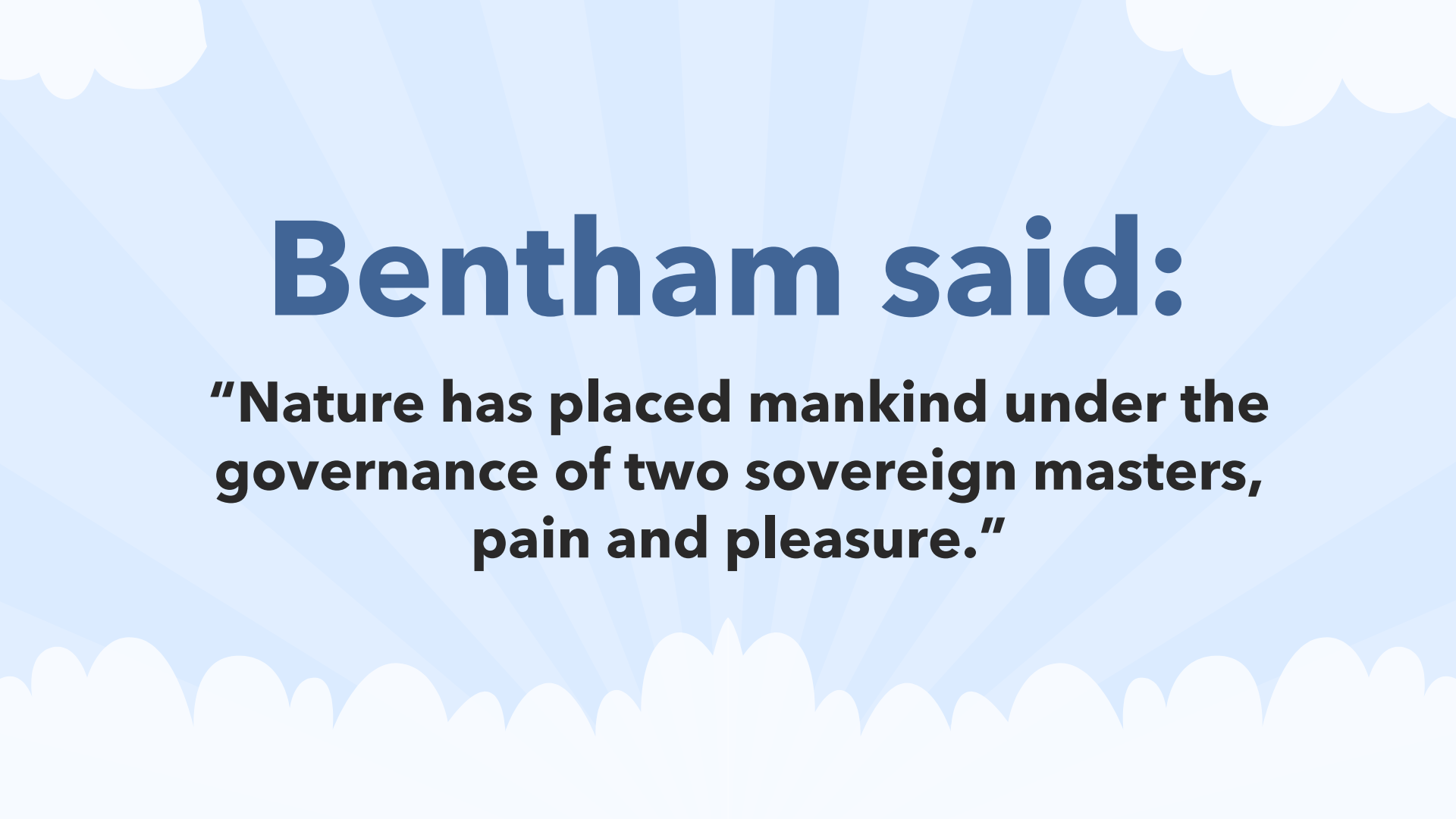


Bentham believed that happiness is pleasure. Below is his hedonistic calculus, dependent largely on the probability of the result:

1. Intensity
2. Duration
3. Certainty
4. Proximity
5. Fecundity
6. Purity
7. Extent



The Hedonic Calculus
Remembering the 7 criteria



Bentham said:

"Nature has placed mankind under the governance of two sovereign masters, pain and pleasure."



3

John Stuart Mill

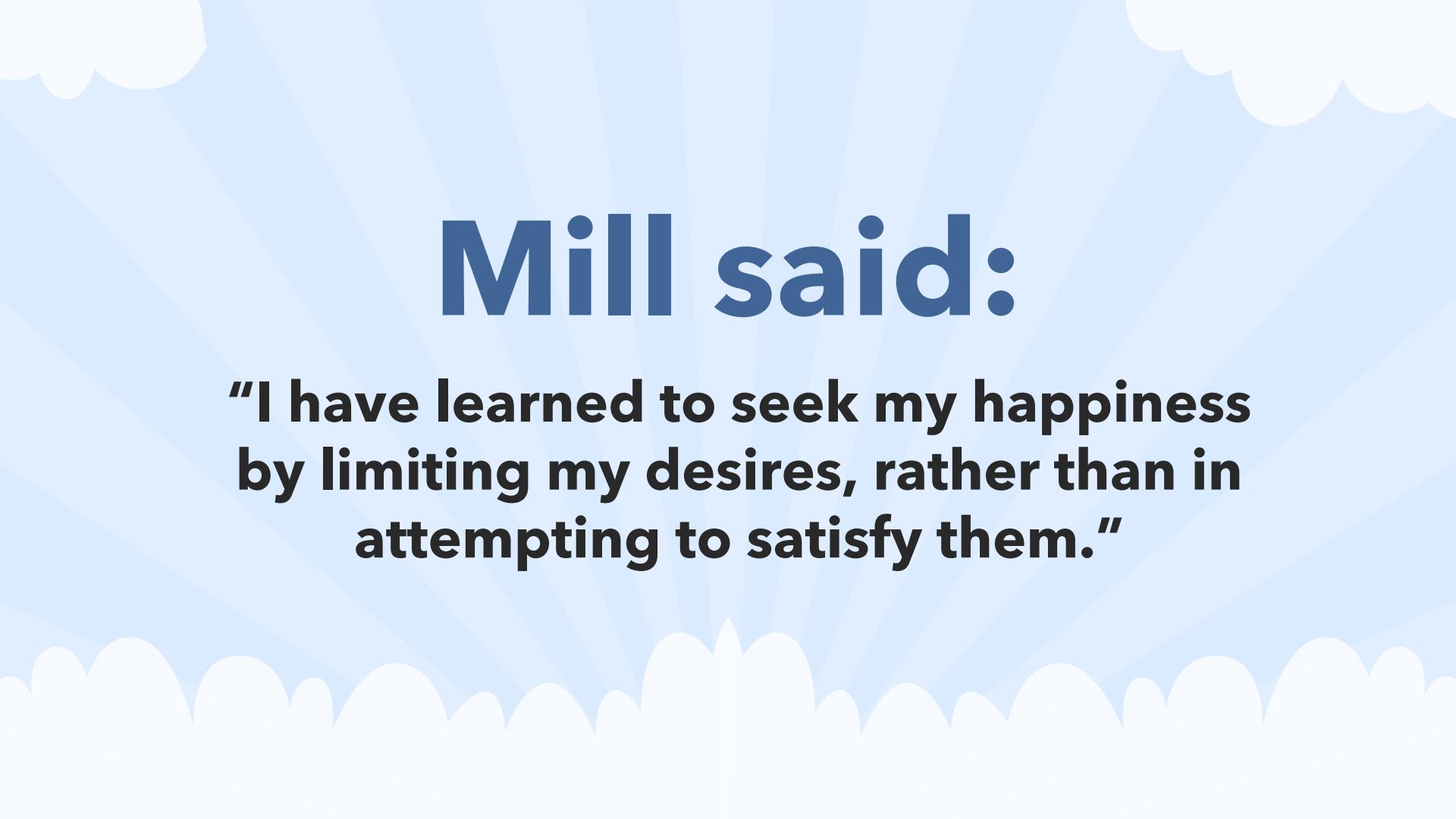




John Stuart Mill's Utilitarianism

He differed from Bentham's view in many key ways. He does not agree with Bentham's idea that all pleasures are of equal value. For him, it is not quantity that should be measured but the quality of the pleasure felt.



The background features a light blue sky with white, fluffy clouds at the top and bottom. In the center, there are several light blue rays emanating from a point, creating a sunburst effect.

Mill said:

"I have learned to seek my happiness by limiting my desires, rather than in attempting to satisfy them."

Bentham versus Mill

Quantity or Quality?

Analysis/Evaluation/Analysis /Evaluation/Analysis /Evaluation

BENTHAM



QUANTITY
of pleasure.
All pleasures
are of equal
value.

*"Push-pin [a
simple child's
game] is as
good as
poetry"*

J.S. MILL: Higher and Lower Pleasures

H
I
G
H
E
R

INTELLECTUAL

QUALITY of pleasure
*"...better to be a
dissatisfied human being
than a pig satisfied; and
better to be a Socrates
dissatisfied than a fool
satisfied"*

L
O
W
E
R

PHYSICAL / BESTIAL



For Mill
intellectual
pleasures are
intrinsically
more valuable
than physical
pleasures.
Those who have
felt both kinds
will prefer
intellectual
pleasure





4

Utilitarianism in Business

The measurement of what will be beneficial will always be at the cost of sacrificing something.





In Business,

"Let me explain to you based on my modest and humblest understanding of Utilitarianism, by using an analogy of Ham Sandwich and Egg Sandwich. To prepare and serve a Ham Sandwich, a poor pig's life must be sacrificed to serve the majority of the consumers—that is Utilitarianism."

(Sillada D.C., Inusara Journal, 2016).





Mill wrote

On Liberty and Wealth of The Nation, the idea for his laissez- faire. This idea promotes minimal interference from the government.

They can have the liberty of choosing what to do with their business and the only way that the government will step in, is when such liberty causes the violation of another person's rights and the protection of the state as a whole.





Laissez- Faire

Thus, in business it also means making decision that will be beneficial to most, while at the same time minimizing the cost (or sacrifice).

**Some debates consistently occur throughout history.
Layoffs vs. quality of product? Jobs vs. environment?
Low salary vs. more jobs? Low cost quantity, vs. high cost quality?**





In the movie, The Avengers: Infinity War. The Antagonist, Thanos wanted to rule the world in order to create balance that will ultimately save the world. However, in doing so, he will kill half of the world's population.

Will you side with the Avengers to stop him, or will you let him do his plan?





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End of Module 2 - Lesson 5